# Playing Video games and their Benefits

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Video games are a part of life in modern society and have been an essential part of life for all ages. We all play or know someone who plays video games, from the big console in the living room, to the smartphone in pocket, to the PC set up for after school use. There is at least one gamer in every household. However, there are some misinterpretations about gaming that imply it's a distraction, it's unhealthy, and it causes laziness. This is not the case when gaming is done in moderation. Gaming helps improve mental skills, emotional stability, and social connections. Therefore, gaming is not a waste of time, but instead, an effective use of time that promotes creativity and critical thinking.

One of the biggest benefits of gaming is how it forces the mind to keep up and work faster. There are so many video games that are memory-based games or require puzzles. For example, first person shooter games or puzzle genre games help players to develop rapid response, decision making and critical thinking skills they might not have on a daily basis. Games can challenge your focus and your ability to think critically as many games have levels that require you to act quickly and correctly. According to the research of Bediou et al. (2018), video games improve attention, memory, and problem solving. Most people who game on a regular basis finds themselves more capable of making faster choices when they want to decide or remember little details better than before.

In addition to cognitive benefits, gaming promotes emotional and social well being. For example, Online multiplayer games like (Fortnite, Minecraft, etc.) requires players from different devices to connect, communicate, plan and solve problems as a team. Therefore, many games promote teamwork as players must learn how to come together and solve the problem as a team. Cole and Griffiths (2007) found that online gaming help builds real friendships and reduce feelings of loneliness. These friends are teammates who have never met IRL but know each other in-game. This proves that video games actually bring people together and make them feel a part of a community.

Another important concept from research involves video gaming's connection with education and life skills. The idea of “gamification” uses elements of games, like levels and rewards, to make school and work tasks more engaging. According to Connolly et al. (2012), games teach problem solving teamwork and motivation skills. For example, in education, Schools use educational games to make learning fun and engaging. Games like

Minecraft Education helps students learn science and building skills together, Marvin Beacons helps students and even adults learn to type more effectively. Therefore, one could say that video gaming is not just and entertainment but can also be a tool for growth, focus and be used in classrooms and jobs

Additionally, myths surrounding video gaming effectively condemn the gamer population. For example, many believe video gaming creates obsessive behavior and isolation. Yet research indicates that in moderation, video gaming promotes self control and an awareness of time management. Granic et al. (2014) found that gaming moderatly helps build resilience and positive habits but can also have negative effect when played excessively. When gamers manage their time efficiently, they can fit gaming in thier routine. Therefore, gaming is not the problem itself but the human relationship with gaming.

In conclusion, video gaming has a lot of benefits when done in moderation. It promotes cognition, resiliency, and social interaction. It also helps with learning and teaches valuable skills like problem solving and teamwork. Instead of viewing video gaming as harmful, one should instead view video gaming as an opportunity to promote creativity, focus, and personal growth. When balanced with daily life, video games can make people happier, smarter, and more connected to others.

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